2011 Toyota Prius Two

$5,980 · 179,328 miles · Dealer · Burbank, CA

Seller: Special Auto Group LLC

Source: CarGurus

Listing: https://www.cargurus.com/details/462932663

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$6,885	**$434**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 6 recalls · 523 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$5,980.00
Sales tax (9.25%)	$553.15
Dealer doc + filing fees	$125.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$38.87
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$6,885.02
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$1,885.02
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$37.77
Total interest over the loan	$381.30
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$37.77
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 50 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$95.00
Maintenance & repair reserve	$150.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$15.74
Total per month	$433.51

Running costs without the loan: **$396/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$11,914** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

Clean-history gen-3 Prius under $6k. At 179k, the EGR and hybrid battery are the main risks.

NHTSA data for this model year: 6 recalls · 523 owner complaints (37 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (277), Electrical System (68), Exterior Lighting (49), Engine (47), Air Bags (46), Vehicle Speed Control (28).

Known issues for this model

• EGR valve/cooler clogging can lead to head-gasket failure around 150–200k (ask if the EGR has been cleaned)

• Inverter coolant pump (covered by a recall; check it was done)

• Hybrid battery age: budget about $1,500–2,500 for a refurbished pack if it weakens

• Brake booster/actuator failure on some cars

Check on this car before buying

• Run the VIN for open recalls

• Hybrid battery health scan (Dr. Prius app + OBD reader, or Toyota of Ridgecrest)

• Check coolant level and for white smoke / overheating (head gasket)

• Pre-purchase inspection before paying

Notes

Added 2026-10-30 (expanded Prius search). CarGurus 'Good Deal'. Clean title, 0 accidents, 3 previous owners. Cheapest clean-history dealer Prius found. About 100–105 miles from Ridgecrest via CA-14 (about 2 hours).

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.